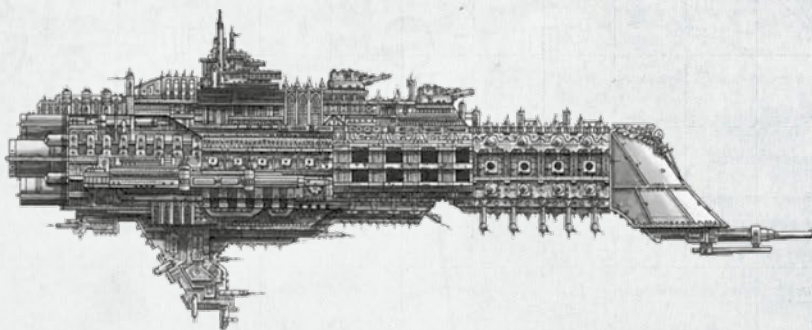


MARS CLASS BATTLECRUISER

270 PTS

Famous Ships of the Gothic War: Imperious



TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS
Cruiser/8	20 cm	45°	2	6+ front / 5+	2
ARMAMENT		RANGE/SPEED		FIREPOWER/STR	FIRE ARC
Port launch bays		Furies: 30 cm Starhawks: 20 cm		2 squadrons	–
Starboard launch bays		Furies: 30 cm Starhawks: 20 cm		2 squadrons	–
Port weapons battery		45 cm		6	Left
Starboard weapons battery		45 cm		6	Right
Dorsal lance battery		60 cm		2	Left/front/right
Prow nova cannon		30–150 cm		1	Front
OPTIONS • Can be retrofitted with a targeting matrix. It gives its weapons batteries a left column shift on the Gunnery table and costs an additional +15 pts (like the <i>Imperious</i>, which was retrofitted with a salvaged targeting matrix after the Battle of Orar). • May purchase a third turret for an additional +10 points.					

The *Imperious* is one of the few surviving examples of the Mars class battlecruiser. Production of these vessels at the Martian shipyards was discontinued over eighteen centuries before the beginning of the Gothic War and the number of ships in service has declined steadily since then. Reckoned to be undergunned by many captains, the Mars class battlecruiser *Imperious* earned its laurels at the outset of the war during a surprise attack on the hive world of Orar. Early in the engagement the *Imperious* managed to get underway and scored a devastating hit on the Slaughter class cruiser *Soulless* with its nova cannon. While *Soulless* was still reeling from the damage a salvo of lance hits from the *Imperious* detonated its plasma core and annihilated it. A wave of Starhawk bombers from the *Imperious* crippled a second Slaughter class cruiser which was subsequently destroyed by Orar's orbital defences, breaking the back of the Chaos attack with minimal damage to Imperial forces. Captain Compel Bast of the *Imperious* was subsequently awarded the Solar Cluster for the heroic actions of his ship and crew.

FLEET LISTS Gothic Sector Fleet List (pg. 33), Bastion Fleets List (pg. 34), Armageddon Sector Fleet List (pg. 38)